RONAH ANKUNDA

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity graduate professional with hands-on experience in SIEM monitoring (Splunk, QRadar), incident triage, and endpoint security. Proven ability to analyze suspicious activity, reduce false positives, and document actionable findings in regulated environments. Currently researching LLM-based spear-phishing detection to improve classification accuracy and threat identification.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Tools: Splunk, QRadar, Wireshark, Snort, AccessData FTK, endpoint security basics

Security skills: Incident Response, Threat Detection, Log Analysis, Alert Triage, Digital Forensics, Compliance Monitoring

System & Platforms: Windows 10/11, Linux, Microsoft 365, AWS (basic), Azure (basic)

Programming & Data: Python, SQL, network fundamentals

Support & Operations: Ticketing Systems, Device Deployment, Technical Documentation, Mobile (Android/iOS)

EXPERIENCE

IT Graduate Assistant | *Hood College - Frederick, MD* Jan 2026 - Present

- Deployed and configured laptops and devices for faculty, staff, and students across campus.
- Resolved software, access, and hardware requests via ticketing system; escalated complex issues to senior IT staff.
- Produced technical guides and user-facing documentation to reduce repeat support requests.

Security Analyst Intern | *Forensics Options Ltd - Kampala, Uganda* Dec 2022 - Jul 2024

- Monitored SIEM dashboards (Splunk, QRadar) to detect and triage security incidents, reducing response time by 25%.
- Investigated suspicious events by analyzing logs, user activity, and endpoint alerts to support incident response.
- Documented findings and managed escalation workflows in collaboration with senior analysts.
- Supported compliance reporting and security monitoring for banking and telecom clients in regulated environments.

Retail Analyst | *Yalelo Uganda Ltd - Kampala, Uganda* Jan 2021 - Oct 2022

- Used Microsoft Dynamics 365 to track inventory and sales, identifying anomalies to support operational decisions.
- Assisted with system maintenance and troubleshooting to maintain up time and reduce disruptions.

Banking Officer | *Equity Bank Uganda Ltd - Kampala, Uganda* Jun 2019 - Dec 2020

- Coordinated with IT to resolve user access issues and maintain stability of online banking systems.
- Processed 450+ daily transactions involving sensitive client data in full compliance with security policies.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Cybersecurity - Hood College, Frederick, MD Expected May 2026 | GPA: 3.77

Bachelor of Science in Office and Information Management - Makerere University, Uganda Jan 2019 | GPA: 3.63

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) (Expected June 2026) | **Splunk Core Certified User** (Jul 2025) | **Google Cybersecurity Certificate** (Mar 2024)

RESEARCH & PROJECTS

Graduate Capstone - LLM Spear-Phishing Detection (CYBR 560): Evaluated LLMs (DeepSeek-R1, Llama 4 Scout, Qwen 2.5-72B) for spear-phishing detection using structured datasets, focusing on classification accuracy, false-positive reduction, and consistency in threat identification. Qwen achieved best overall performance with near-perfect detection rates.

GitHub: ronah-ankunda/llm-phishing-detection-capstone | https://github.com/ronah-ankunda/snort-icmp-lab